

THE BA JIRA CHECKLIST

12 habits that make Jira easier to live with, plus a Definition of Ready check for every ticket.

WHEN A TICKET FEELS MESSY

"It's not the tool. It's the information design."

Clear context, explicit decisions, visible dependencies and testable acceptance criteria make Jira much easier to work with.

1 CLONE, DON'T RECREATE

Reuse the closest matching ticket's structure, then update the requirement and re-check links.

2 CONTEXT BEFORE STORY

A developer should understand the problem before reading "As a... I want..."

3 TESTABLE AC

If QA can't call a clear pass or fail, the acceptance criterion is too vague.

4 LINK, DON'T DESCRIBE

Model dependencies as linked issues — searchable and traceable, unlike a paragraph.

5 RULES VS. AC

Business rules describe how the business works; AC describes system behaviour.

6 LABELS AS TAXONOMY

Agree what a label means before the team starts using it, not after.

7 FILTERS YOU'LL REUSE

Save the JQL searches you run every week instead of hunting each time.

8 A BA DASHBOARD

Show where thinking or decisions are stuck — not just ticket status.

9 DECISIONS, NOT COMMENTS

Record the resulting decision, owner and date — not the conversation.

10 DEFINITION OF READY

A ticket existing is not the same as a ticket being ready. Check below.

11 SUBTASKS FOR REAL WORK

Trackable delivery pieces, not a personal to-do list inside the ticket.

12 ONE MASTER TEMPLATE

Every new ticket starts from the same complete structure, not a blank page.

DEFINITION OF READY — BEFORE A TICKET LEAVES YOUR DESK

☐ Business problem understood

☐ Business rules identified

☐ Data requirements understood

☐ Open questions resolved

☐ Acceptance criteria written

☐ Dependencies linked

☐ Designs available if required

☐ Test approach understood

REMEMBER

You don't need more Jira. You need clearer Jira.

Clear context, explicit decisions, visible dependencies and testable acceptance criteria make the tool much easier to work with.